ARTICLE 38. To see if the Town will vote to amend the Code of Bylaws Chapter II by adding the following Section 4-9, making the Committee on Names a standing committee of Town Meeting; or take any other action in relation thereto.

4.9. Committee on Names.

4.9.1. Establishment.
There shall be a Committee on Names having the responsibilities and organized in the manner described below.

4.9.2. Composition; Term of Office.
The Committee on Names shall consist of seven (7) voting members, as follows:

- The Town Moderator, or their designee.
- One (1) member of the Select Board, designated by the Select Board.
- One (1) member of the School Committee, designated by the School Committee.
- One (1) member of the Planning Board, designated by the Planning Board.
- One (1) member of the Historical Commission or Historical Society, or, if such a member is unavailable or unwilling to serve, a Winchester resident with experience in local history or archival work, designated by the Town Manager.
- Two (2) registered Winchester voters serving at-large, appointed by the Select Board to alternating two-year terms, who shall hold no other Town office, excluding Town Meeting, with preference given to Town Meeting members.

The Committee shall also include the Town Historian/Archivist as a nonvoting (ex-officio) member.

4.9.3. Duties.
The Committee on Names shall maintain guidelines for the naming of public facilities, places, structures, and streets within the Town of Winchester and publish those guidelines on the town website.

The Committee on Names shall meet from time to time to evaluate proposals for the naming of public facilities, places, structures, and streets within the Town of Winchester.

The Committee on Names shall research each proposal and hold a public meeting to hear testimony from the public. Following its review, the Committee shall make a recommendation regarding the proposal to Town Meeting or the municipal body or authority responsible for the facility, place, structure, or street.

4.9.4. Naming Suggestions.
Suggestions for the naming of public facilities, places, structures, and streets should be made to the Committee on Names through its process as published on the Town website. Submissions must be accompanied by the signatures of fifty (50) registered voters who reside in Winchester.

Proposals to name facilities, places, structures, or streets after living individuals are strongly discouraged, as are proposals involving individuals who have died within the previous five years. No vote shall be taken at the meeting at which a proposal is first presented. Favorable Committee recommendations on proposals involving living individuals shall require a unanimous vote of those present.

4.9.5. Quorum.
A quorum will consist of four (4) members.

4.9.6. Filling of Vacancies.
Whenever a vacancy occurs on the Committee, it shall be filled in the manner set forth in Subsection **4.9.2** above.

4.10. Advisory Nature and Authority. The Committee on Names is advisory in nature and shall not supersede the School Committee's authority to make a final determination concerning public facilities, places, and structures within the School Committee's custody and control, in accordance with state law.

(Committee on Names)

MOTION: MOVED AND SECONDED that the Town approve Article 38 as printed below:

4.9. Committee on Names.

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4.9.2. Composition; Term of Office.
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BACKGROUND: *Section 4.10 was removed from the bylaw that was written in the warrant.*

This article formally establishes the Committee on Names as a standing committee within the Town of Winchester's structural bylaws and updates the framework established by Town Meeting in 1977. The Committee was established to evaluate suggestions for naming public places and structures. This article codifies that longstanding municipal function, adds street naming to the Committee's charge, and establishes a clear, consistent, and transparent process for evaluating naming proposals.

Composition and Structure Changes:
As outlined in Section 4.9.2, the voting body will consist of seven (7) members strategically designated from key town stakeholders to ensure balanced administrative representation:

- *Designated Voting Members/Designees: The Town Moderator (or their designee), and one member each from the Select Board, School Committee, and Planning Board.*
- *Historical Representation: One member from the Historical Commission/Society (or a designated resident with local archival experience).*
- *Community Members: Two registered Winchester voters serving at-large (two-year alternating terms), giving explicit preference to active Town Meeting members.*
- *Non-Voting Expertise: The Town Historian/Archivist will serve as a non-voting member to provide critical preservation context.*

Municipal Duties and Transparency:
Under Section 4.9.3, the Committee will hold a broader scope of responsibility than previous iterations. In addition to public places, structures, and facilities, the committee will now maintain guidelines for naming town streets. To guarantee transparency and public access, the bylaw mandates that the committee must:

1. *Publish official naming guidelines directly on the town website.*
2. *Formally research each submitted naming proposal.*
3. *Hold public meetings specifically to hear open testimony from town residents before advancing any recommendation to the Town Meeting floor.*

Cost, Funding, and Vote Requirement:

- *Financial Impact: This bylaw change introduces no immediate appropriations of funds or municipal costs.*
- *Voting Requirement: A simple Majority Vote is required to adopt this standard regulatory amendment to the Town Code of Bylaws*

Majority Vote Required